

Dongkeun Choi

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EDUCATION	Ph.D. in Economics, University of California San Diego	2027 (expected)
	M.A. in Economics, Korea University	2021
	B.A. in Economics and B.S. in Financial Engineering, Korea University	2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS Macroeconomics, Monetary Economics, Financial Intermediaries

REFERENCES	James D. Hamilton (Main Advisor) Professor Department of Economics UC San Diego jhamilton@ucsd.edu	Juan Herreño Assistant Professor Department of Economics UC San Diego jherrenolopera@ucsd.edu
	Michael Reher Associate Professor Rady School of Management UC San Diego mreher@ucsd.edu	Johannes Wieland Professor Department of Economics UC San Diego jfwieland@ucsd.edu

JOB MARKET PAPER **Unintended Risks of Bank Capital Regulations**
***Abstract.** Nonbank financial intermediaries (NBFIs) have reemerged as major U.S. credit suppliers. Using loan-level mortgage data, I document that NBFI-originated loans exhibit looser underwriting standards and higher default rates than bank loans. In addition, tighter capital requirements are associated with both NBFI expansion and a shift toward borrowers with riskier profiles. I develop a general equilibrium model in which banks and NBFIs choose loan rates and underwriting standards. Banks fund their lending with deposits subject to capital requirements, while NBFIs rely on market-based funding outside the regulatory perimeter. Tighter capital requirements shift origination toward NBFIs, raising defaults through changes in the composition of underlying risks. Introducing underwriting regulations governing NBFI lending reduces credit losses more effectively than tightening bank capital requirements.*

WORKING PAPERS **Equipment, Structures, and the Limits of Investment-Specific Technological Change** (with Munseob Lee)

WORK IN PROGRESS Why Is Monetary Policy Less Effective at Low Interest Rates: The Role of Banking Sector Redistribution through the Secondary Mortgage Market

RESEARCH	Dissertation Fellow, Federal Reserve Board		Summer 2026
EXPERIENCE	Research Assistant, Prof. Munseob Lee (UC San Diego)		2022 – 2023
	Research Assistant, Prof. Jinill Kim (Korea University)		2020 – 2021
PRESENTATIONS	2026	Federal Reserve Board, Midwest Macro Meeting (Milwaukee), FIRS (Miami), UCSD	
	<2025	UCSD, SOCAE	
TEACHING	UC San Diego – Teaching Assistant		
EXPERIENCE	• Long Run Macroeconomics (UG)		2022
	• Short Run Macroeconomics (UG)		2023 – 2026
	• Macroeconomics B (G)		2023
	• Macroeconomics C (G)		2023
	Korea University – Teaching Assistant		
	• Intermediate Macroeconomics (UG)		2020 – 2021
	• Macroeconomics I & II (G)		2020 – 2021
FELLOWSHIPS,	FIRS PhD Student Travel Grant		2026
GRANTS, AND	Travel and Research Grant, UC San Diego		2026
AWARDS	Clive Granger Research Fellowship, UC San Diego		2025
	Research Fellowships, Prof. James D. Hamilton, UC San Diego		2024, 2025
	Summer Research Fellowships, UC San Diego		2022, 2023
	Regent Fellowship, UC San Diego		2021 – 2022
	Research Grant, Korea Foundation of Abroad Studies (KFAS)		2021 – 2026
	Brain Korea 21+ Graduate Student Scholarship, Korea University		2019 – 2020
	President’s List, Korea University		Spring 2017
ADDITIONAL	Programming	Matlab, Dynare, Stata, Python	
INFORMATION	Languages	English (fluent), Korean (native)	
	Citizenship	South Korea (F-1 Visa)	